RETHINKING CULTURAL COMPETENCE

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Introduction

- There are many cultural competence assessment tools available for individuals and organizations. Oftentimes, there is no long term follow through after these assessments are taken.
- There have also been many attempts to define cultural competence, but a consensus has yet to be reached (Johnson, 2006).
- The overall purpose of this study is to compare cultural competence assessment tools and their respective developmental plans.

Research Questions

1. **How should cultural competence be defined within Higher Education settings?**
2. **What are some of the most commonly used cultural competence assessment tools or models within Higher Education settings? How do they compare to one another?**

Methodology

The researchers developed a qualitative critical case study that reviewed literature obtained through online databases in relation to cultural competence assessments and their effectiveness over time.

Preliminary Findings

Question 1. Definition of Cultural Competence

Findings from this study revealed that the most agreed upon definition of cultural competence by academic scholars and administrators was a compilation of Deardorff (2004) and Deardorff (2006), which states:

> "The ability to communicate effectively and appropriately in intercultural competence situations based on one's intercultural knowledge, attitudes, both cognitive and comparative thinking skills, and cognitive flexibility."

Question 2. Some of the Most Used Cultural Competence Models

The four main models used by administrators and higher education scholars:

- Diversity Awareness Profile (DAP)
- Global Competencies Inventory (GCI)
- Intercultural Effectiveness Scale (IES)
- Intercultural Development Inventory (IDI)

Question 2. Continued

	DAP	GCI	IES	IDI
Administration of Test				
Cost	$50	$130	$12	$15
Seminar attendance required		x		x
Can be taken as an organization		x	x	x
Test Format				
# of Questions 0≥50	x			x
# of Questions 50<x		x	x	
Online		x	x	x
Paper/ Pencil	x			x
Developmental Stages				
How the stages are measured	**Measured on 5 levels:** -Naïve Offenders -Perpetuator -Avoider -Change Agent -Fighter	**Measured (3) Intercultural Adaptability factors:** -Perception Management -Relationship Management -Self Management **Together they encompass sixteen (16) different dimensions**	**Measures (3) Intercultural Adaptability factors:** -Continuous Learning -Interpersonal Engagement -Hardiness **Together they encompass six (6) different dimensions**	**Measures 5 core mindsets and behaviors:** -Denial -Polarization -Minimization -Acceptance -Adaptation **Also measured into:** ***Ethnocentric Stages** -Denial -Defense -Minimization ***Ethnorelative Stages** -Acceptance -Adaptation -Integration
Action Plans				
All include action plans				
What the plan consists of	Action plan that makes a person analyze what they: **Do well, need to do, goals they want to set, resources they have**	Helps create a "Personal Development Plan" through: **Assessment**: *Pick the weakest competency area* **General Plans**: *List a few broad objectives to help narrow focus* **Tactics:** *include measurable action steps* **Reporting Results:** *Share results with others*	Similar development plan as Global Competencies Inventory, but different wording: **Assessment, Tactics, Support, Accountability**	Profile reports are accompanied by a separate customized **Intercultural Development Plan,** for individuals, and follow-up trainings are available for groups

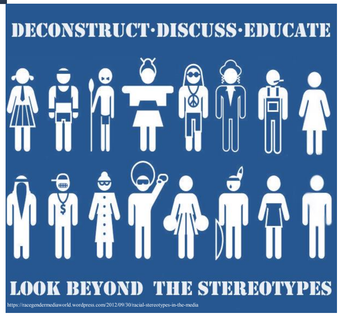
Discussion

- Although there was a limited consensus reached by scholars and administrators, as to what cultural competence could mean it is still an ambiguous definition (see preliminary finding 1).
- The models researched still lack overall specificity and have an overall ambiguity to them.
- Cultural competence assessments are a great starting point, but developmental plans are fundamental to improvement.
- It is important that we also understand how others exist in the world around them as well as how we exist in our own world.









Limitations

- Only able to provide a limited review of the literature in relation to four (4) cultural competence models.
- Was not able to create a study in which evaluations could be taken from live participants.
- May be difficult to create a study that measures overall increase in cultural competence because it is continuously being shifted by a person's experiences.

References

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